

# Talal Abid Alharbi

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Portfolio: talalalharbi.com | github.com/TalalAlha

## Summary

Information Technology graduate (GPA 4.79/5.00, First Class Honors, King Abdulaziz University) specializing in cybersecurity with a strong foundation across development, networking, and security operations. Demonstrated adaptability across technical and leadership roles, from architecting a bilingual phishing simulation platform to engaging 100+ staff and students during KAU's Cybersecurity Awareness Month. Holder of CompTIA CySA+, Security+, and eJPTv2, eager to leverage this academic and practical foundation to drive impactful initiatives within a structured IT and cybersecurity environment

## Education

**Bachelor of Information Technology, King Abdulaziz University**  
Faculty of Computing and Information Technology

2022 – Jun 2026  
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

- GPA 4.79 / 5.00 - First Class Honors
- Relevant coursework: Networking, Database Systems, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Information Security, IT Project Management.

## Certifications

- CompTIA CySA+ | Aug 2026
- INE eJPTv2 | Feb 2026
- CompTIA Security+ | Sep 2025

## Experience

**Information Technology Intern, Deanship of E-Learning, King Abdulaziz University**

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025  
Jeddah, Saudi Arabia

- Developed and implemented a web-based booking system for 100+ faculty members, translating business requirements into a functional application
- Collaborated in a 5-person agile team, rotating across frontend, backend, UX/UI, database, and system analysis, delivering a functional booking system within a 3-month timeline.
- Participated in sprint planning and peer code reviews, contributing to iterative development cycles and maintaining code quality throughout the project lifecycle.

## Projects

**PhishAware | Phishing Simulation & Security Awareness Platform**

- Led a cross-functional development team and worked with academic supervisors to architect a bilingual phishing simulation platform tailored for the MENA region's social engineering landscape aligned with NCA ECC Controls and framework.
- Built a custom AI email generation model from scratch, producing 500+ culturally localised Arabic and English phishing templates aligned to MENA social engineering patterns.

**Personal Cybersecurity Infrastructure**

- Deployed and hardened a production Linux server with SSH key-only auth, UFW firewall, Cloudflare WAF, and A+ SSL Labs rating, detected and responded to a real intrusion attempt via Fail2Ban, logging attacker behaviour and reporting the abuse.
- Penetration tested the server using Kali Linux and Nessus, identified and remediated a TLS 1.0/1.1 exposure on Cloudflare; built a custom Python/Flask security scanner scoring the site 96/100 across headers, SSL, and DNS.

## Skills

**Security Core:** Penetration Testing, Vulnerability Assessment, Cyber Threat Analysis, Network Security, Incident Response, SOC.

**Development:** Java, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, SQL.

**Security Tools:** Metasploit, Nmap, Kali Linux, PowerShell, Linux CLI, Nessus, SIEM.

**Operations & Networking:** GitHub, VS Code, Network Protocols, Firewalls, IDS/IPS, TCP/IP & OSI Model, Microsoft Office.

**Soft Skills:** Communication, Leadership, Adaptability, Ambition, Cross-functional Collaboration, Agility, Continuous Learning

## Volunteer Experience

**Cybersecurity Awareness Month | King Abdulaziz University**

Oct 2025

Led a cybersecurity awareness booth during KAU's Cybersecurity Awareness Month (Oct 2025), engaging 100+ students and staff on phishing, password hygiene, and safe digital practices.

## Languages

**Arabic**  
Native

**English**  
Proficient - STEP: 95/100